

Duped to sell your soul

Game Station recently slipped a clause into its T&C that gave the company rights to the purchaser's soul. 7500 people fell for it!



Google profits

Google posted a staggering 37 per cent rise in first quarter profits for this year. Looks like the China debacle did little to the giant



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some features that are already in action. Here are some of the highlights:

- Twitter is working on a feature called Points of Interest, which will provide support for working with Geo-location features.



- Twitter introduced a whole bunch of new API features, such as the new User Stream feature, which will allow desktop applications to work with users' posts, retweets, direct messages and response; all in one development model.

Toshiba and HTC jump into the tablets fray

While speaking with Reuters about Toshiba's amazing Q1 sales in the United States (50% increase since the previous quarter), Jeff Barney, GM Digital Products for Toshiba America, let slip some information about Toshiba's upcoming tablet devices.

Two tablets were mentioned by Barney, one – a 10-inch Windows 7 device with two screens, two – a smaller Android device that will be cheaper but customisable. Both devices are meant for “media consumption” as their “main user activity”, and Barney said that they will try to position it in a way that it will not eat into its growing laptop sales.

Toshiba already offers tablets in the Japanese and European markets (pictured below is the European device - Journe Touch - a MID that runs on Windows CE), and says it will introduce its two new slates late this year or early next year.

In related news, during a press conference mid April, in Johannesburg, local HTC Managing Director Quinton Leigh revealed some very interesting scoops regarding the mobile phone manufacturer's future plans. Some reports suggest HTC will be offering phones with full 5.1 channel sound, in collaboration with Yamaha, before Q2 2011. Developments are not planned only in the audio space. HTC will be offering phones that have full HD video recording (1080p) by the same time. The most interesting announcement was that HTC will be



Toshiba tablet

developing an Android-based tablet. Leigh was ambiguous about the product, going so far as to say it might not be a tablet at all, but no details are available about when it will be released, or what exact form it will take (possibly featuring Wi-Fi and HSPA connectivity).

The news of the tablet is even more pertinent at this time, as HTC's smartbook (XP/Vista-based UMPCs - Ultra Mobile Personal Computers) range in the recent past had a terrible time in the market before being discontinued. It will also be another field where Apple and HTC can lock horns head-to-head.

Kojima's next game is a certain type of Taboo

Legendary game developer and Metal Gear creator Hideo Kojima tweeted out news of his “next project” mid April, causing much speculation. He finally confirmed what the project would be, but not after building much suspense. Kojima says it will raise a few eyebrows, and if he doesn't manage to pull it off, his days in the industry might be numbered. Too much honour Kojima san! He also complained that while he had much

remaining to do on the PSP title Metal Gear Solid: Peace Walker, he is already in “The Next Title Mode” and that “The next project will challenge a certain type of taboo. If I mess up, I'll probably have to leave the industry. However, I don't want to pass by avoiding that.”

Amongst other things such as casting, story etc. he happened to speak about mechs. Fans have observed that the mention of “mechs” might mean that Kojima is planning a new version of Zone of the Enders, a PlayStation 2 game that released in 2001, with a sequel in 2003. In the latest news however, Kojima confirmed that the game will be

called Zone of the Enders 3, in an interview with PlayStation Magazine UK: “I would like to say that Zone of the Enders is quite near the priority list... [after MGS4] it might be good to change to outer space or robots or things like that for a change”. Though we don't yet know what will be so “taboo” of a new Zone of Enders game, we can't wait for some screenshots! If you remember the innovative mech combat from the two originals as vividly as many of its fans do, you'd be very excited too!

Philips TVs will now be made by Videocon

The consumer electronics giant in an announcement recently said it has outsourced everything from manufacturing, distribution and sales of its TV business to Videocon. Philips Electronics India Managing Director and CEO Murali Sivaraman said the agreement was aimed at bringing the TV business back into profitability from 2010 onwards. Looks like Philips was losing badly to Samsung and LG, the Korean market breakers.

The agreement which is a five year contract is based on a similar format Philips followed in the US when they outsourced manufacturing to Japanese firm Funai. The Netherlands based company has been operating in India for nearly 80 years is focusing more on the health-care, lifestyle and lighting equipment segment going forward. Mr. Murali was also quick to tell reporters that the TVs manufactured by Videocon would be according to the specifications and standards maintained by Philips globally. Well lets hope so. **d**